

YPRES 1914–1918: FLANDERS FIELDS & LOCAL HERITAGE

3-Day Immersive Study Tour · Thursday 1st – Saturday 3rd October 2026

Base: Peace Village Hostel
Mesen (Messines), Belgium

3-DAY FIELD EXPEDITION ITINERARY

DAY 1 THU 1 OCT

Departure, North Salient & Mine Warfare

- **06:15 Meet at Meoncross:** 06:30 coach departure; Eurotunnel Le Shuttle crossing to Calais.
- **14:30 Essex Farm ADS:** John McCrae dugout ('In Flanders Fields') & 15-year-old Pte Strudwick.
- **15:15 Langemarck Cemetery:** The somber *Studentenfriedhof* & German commemoration.
- **16:00 Hooze Crater Museum:** Preserved frontline trenches, deep mine craters & archaeology.
- **17:45 Peace Village Hostel:** Check-in at Mesen, 2-course dinner & evening study debrief.

DAY 2 FRI 2 OCT

Passchendaele Ridge, Medical Care & The Menin Gate

- **09:15 Vancouver Corner:** Brooding Soldier memorial & 1915 gas attacks analysis.
- **09:45 Sanctuary Wood (Hill 62):** Authentic preserved British frontline trenches & tunnels.
- **11:30 Supermarket Lunch Stop:** Supervised stop in Ypres (pupils select lunch with Euros).
- **13:00 Tyne Cot Cemetery:** World's largest CWGC cemetery; locating our local fallen.
- **14:15 Lijssenthoek Cemetery:** Casualty Clearing Station medical care & Nurse Nellie Spindler.
- **15:45 Passchendaele Museum:** 20ft underground dugout system & recreated trenches.
- **20:00 Menin Gate Ceremony:** Solemn Last Post Ceremony, wreath-laying & Panel 35 tribute.

DAY 3 SAT 3 OCT

Daylight Menin Gate, Civilian Rebirth & Poperinge

- **09:15 Daylight Menin Gate:** Architectural study & morning walk atop Ypres Ramparts.
- **10:30 Grote Markt & Chocolatier:** Supervised visit to De Groote chocolatier for gift shopping.
- **11:20 Talbot House (Poperinge):** Historic 'Every Man's Club' soldiers' sanctuary & chapel.
- **12:45 Town Centre Lunch & Death Cells:** Supervised lunch; visiting preserved execution cells.
- **14:30 Return Journey:** Depart for Calais; 17:50 Le Shuttle (17:30 UK arrival); ~20:00 at school.



Explore the Expedition on Our Digital Field Companion

Explore the full itinerary, interactive maps, cemetery coordinates, local hero dossiers, and the complete 16-poem anthology from any smartphone or tablet.

 meoncross-history.netlify.app (Select 'History Battlefield Tour')

FOOTWEAR, CLOTHING & TOWELS

- **TOWELS (Mandatory):** Pupils **MUST bring their own bath/shower towel**. The hostel does not provide towels for school groups.
- **Sanctuary Wood Muddy Trenches:** Deep, authentic frontline trenches are wet and muddy. Pupils **MUST bring a separate pair of wellington boots or sturdy walking boots**, plus a clean, separate pair of shoes/trainers for coach and hostel.
- **Sturdy Plastic Bag:** Every pupil must pack a strong plastic bag (or bin liner) in their daypack to seal away muddy boots before boarding the coach!
- **Waterproof Coat:** Hooded rain jacket. We are outdoors regardless of light rain.
- **Warm Layers, Hat & Gloves:** Autumn in Belgium is cold on exposed ridges. Standing still at the 8:00 PM Menin Gate ceremony gets very cold.

FOOD, LUGGAGE, EUROS & DEVICES

- **Day 1 Packed Lunch:** Bring a packed lunch and snacks from home for the coach journey (no fast food at motorway services). Refillable water bottle.
- **Spending Money (€30–€40 Euros):** In cash for supervised Friday & Saturday supermarket lunches (fresh rolls/fruit) and Belgian chocolates.
- **Luggage:** 1 main holdall (<15kg) for coach luggage hold + 1 small daypack inside coach. Casual clothes for hostel. Roll-on deodorant only (**NO aerosols**).
- **Plug Adapter:** European 2-pin adapter for charging devices in bedrooms.
- **Mobile Phone Policy:** Allowed by day for photos and web app. **Collected each night in staff phone bag at curfew** for proper rest.

Accommodation, Safety & Rooming Allocation Timeline

Expedition Base: Peace Village Hostel, Nieuwkerkestraat 9aB, 8957 Mesen, Belgium (Tel: +32 57 226 040 · info@peacevillage.be). Secure rural centre with keycard access, modern ensuite studios (typically 4–7 pupils with bunk beds), and recreational grounds. View facilities & FAQs at: peacevillage.be/en/practical/faq.

Rooming & Dietary Process (In ~2 Weeks): In approximately two weeks, pupils will submit rooming friend requests in school (ensuring every pupil is happily paired with close friends). Parents will also confirm specific dietary options (e.g. vegetarian evening meals; medical allergies are already on school records). Staff sleep on the same corridors with active evening checks.

PARENT ACTION ITEMS & NEXT STEPS

ITEM / ACTION	DETAILS & REQUIREMENTS	DEADLINE
Code of Conduct Form	Signed agreement by pupil & parent (Nut & Sesame Policy).	Return by Fri 25 Sep
Passport & GHIC Collection	Hand in valid UK passport (>3m validity) & GHIC card to Mr Lovett.	Tonight / This Week
Rooming & Dietary Choices	Pupils nominate friend pairs; parents confirm dietary meal choices.	In Approx. 2 Weeks
Euros Currency (€)	Provide €30–€40 cash for Fri & Sat supermarket lunches & gifts.	For Departure Day

Expedition Staff: Mr B. Lovett & Mr J. Garrett (Tour Leaders) · 2
Accompanying Staff

School Base 24/7 Emergency: **+44 (0)1329 662182**